

DECODED EXPLAINED

22nd July, 2026

Recap



Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

Beta Pictoris b: hide and seek

Associated Press

Astronomers have discovered a faint, elusive planet orbiting a young star after more than a decade of cosmic hide-and-seek. In an unusual twist, two groups working independently detected the cold gas giant a few days apart late last year using different telescopes. It's the dimmest planet ever directly imaged from earth, scientists said.

A Scottish and German-led team spied the new planet around the star Beta Pictoris using the European Southern Observatory's Very Large Telescope in Chile, then dug through archives to confirm its orbit. The planet had remained hidden in the data all this time, overshadowed by its considerably brighter star and two companion planets. Beta Pictoris is located in the easel-shaped southern constellation Pictor and 63 light-years from earth.

A California-led team made the discovery with NASA's Webb Space Telescope. Two observations were all it took with Webb, the biggest telescope ever launched into space. Both teams reported their findings in the *Astrophysical Journal Letters* on July 15.

Each team was studying one of the star's already identified planets when they spotted a less massive one



This image provided by the European Southern Observatory shows the Beta Pictoris region on March 6, 2014. ESO/AP

100-times fainter lurking farther out. They deliberately kept their work from one another so as not to bias the results.

The new planet is slightly bigger than Jupiter and takes 91 years to orbit its star, a little longer than it takes Uranus to orbit our sun. Born into a star system barely 20 million years old, the planet is probably similar to a much younger Jupiter, said the University of California San Diego's Aidan Gibbs, who led the second team.



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Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

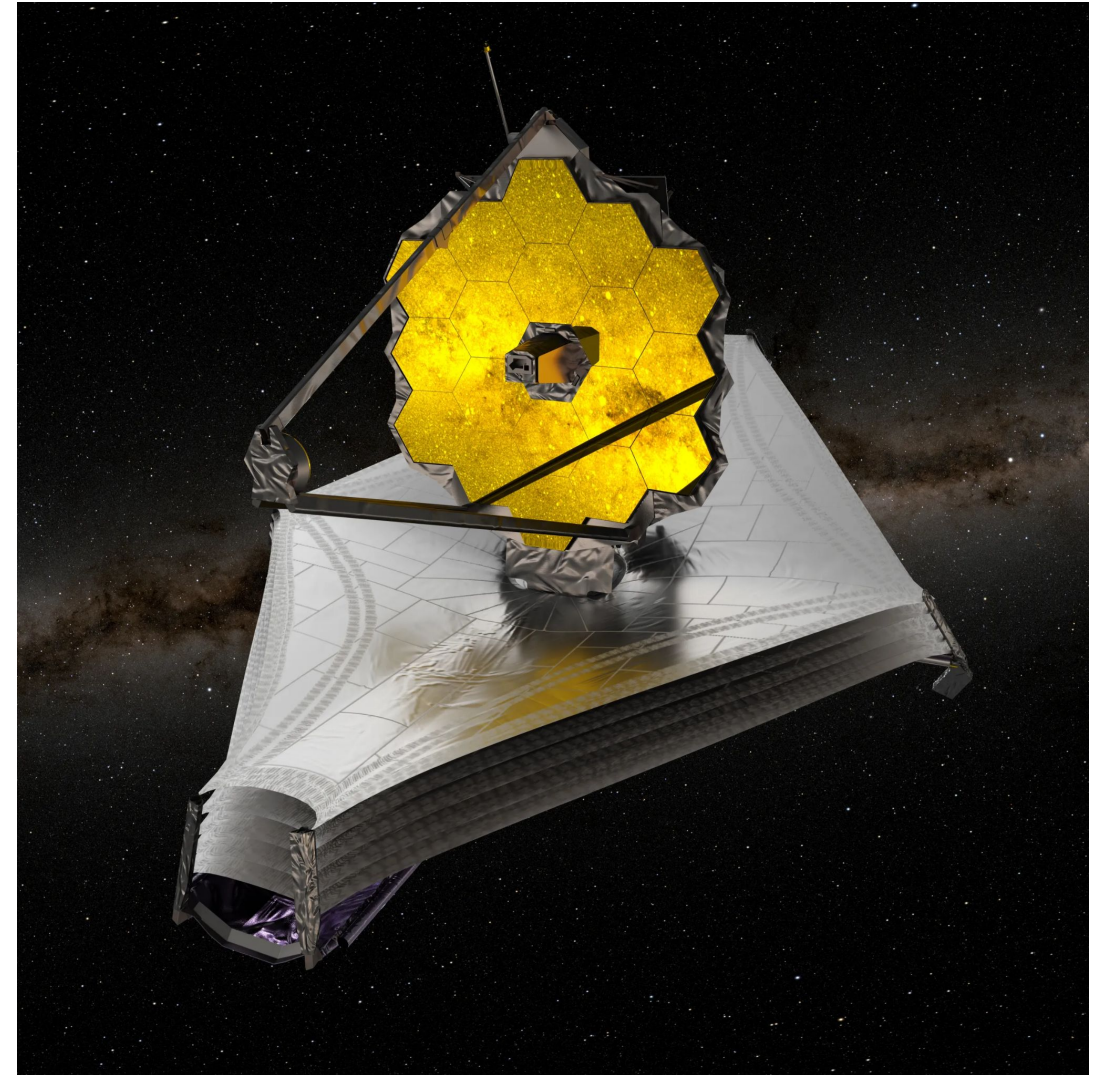
James Webb Telescope

The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) is a monumental leap in space exploration and astrophysics.

Launched on December 25, 2021, it is the largest and most powerful space telescope ever built, serving as the premier space-based observatory for the next decade.

Developed by NASA with contributions from the European and Canadian space agencies, JWST is designed to observe the universe primarily in the infrared spectrum.

Successor to Hubble: It has been conceived as the next-generation space telescope succeeding the Hubble Space Telescope, with a focus on infrared astronomy



Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

Infrared optimisation: Designed primarily for infrared astronomy to observe objects which were too old, distant, or faint for visible light detection.

Large primary mirror: Equipped with a 6.5-meter diameter primary mirror to capture more light and provide higher-resolution images.

Segmented mirror design: The primary mirror comprises 18 hexagonal, gold-coated beryllium segments, thus enabling it to fold for launch and unfold in space.

Sunshield protection: A five-layer sun-shield, which blocks solar light and heat, maintaining the instruments at extremely low temperatures necessary for infrared observations.

Location at Lagrange Point 2 (L2): Operates from a stable orbit around the Sun-Earth L2 point thereby minimising light interference and reducing fuel consumption for orbital corrections.

High sensitivity: Its instruments are highly sensitive to infrared light thus enabling the study of the earliest stars and galaxies formed after the Big Bang.

Cryogenic cooling system: Uses a passive cooling system to reach temperatures as low as 40 Kelvin (-233°C) which is essential for infrared observations.

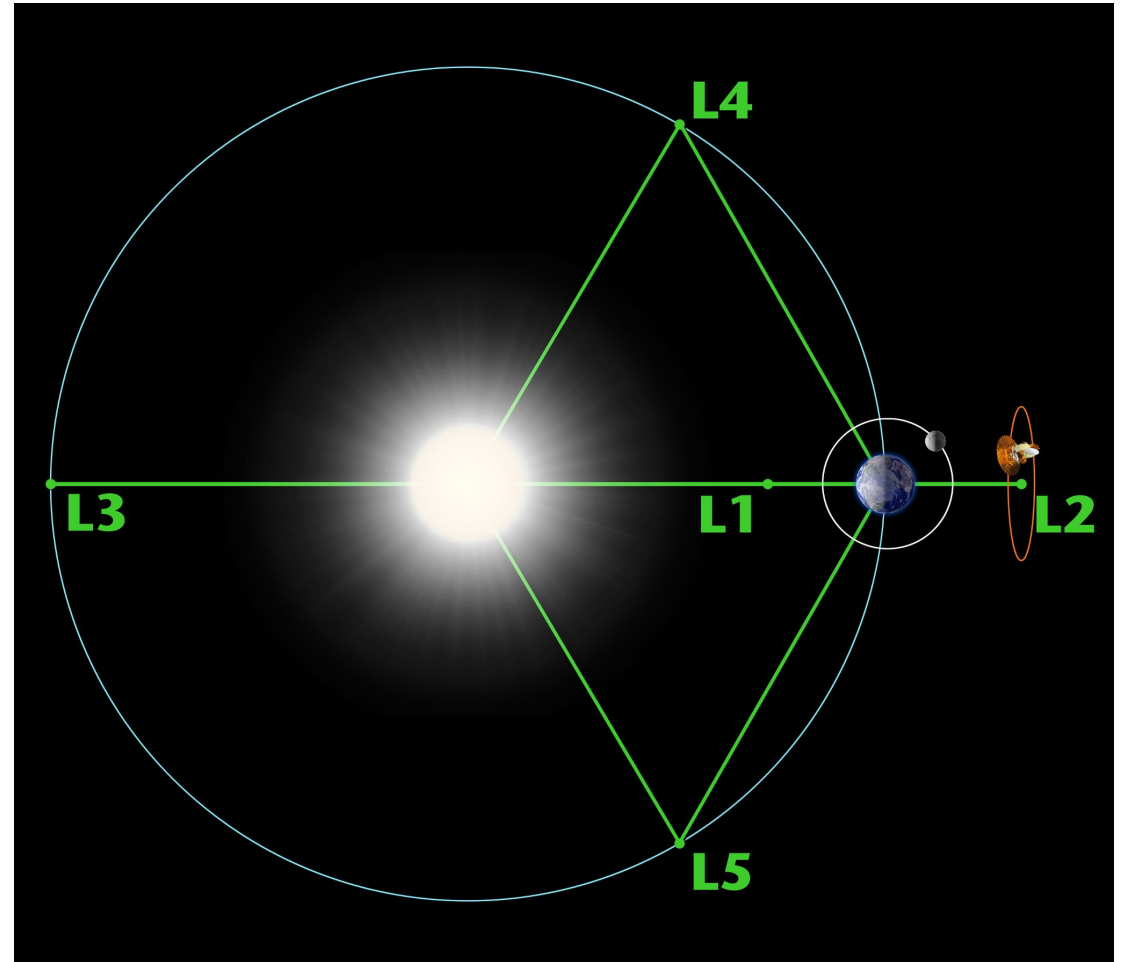
Precision guidance sensors: Equipped with sophisticated guidance sensors for accurate pointing and stability. This is crucial for long-duration observations of faint celestial objects.

Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

Lagrange Points are special positions in space where objects placed there tend to stay in a stable or nearly stable position.

Spacecraft placed at these points require very little fuel to remain in position, making them extremely useful for satellites, telescopes, and space observatories.

Of the five Lagrange points, three are unstable and two are stable. The unstable Lagrange points - labeled L1, L2 and L3 - lie along the line connecting the two large masses. The stable Lagrange points - labeled L4 and L5 - form the apex of two equilateral triangles that have the large masses at their vertices.



Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) offers numerous benefits for humanity in various ways:

- Advancing astrophysical knowledge
- Exoplanet exploration
- Educational and scientific collaboration
- Catalyst for future space missions

James Webb Space Telescope (JWST)	Hubble Space Telescope.
Optimized for infrared astronomy, allowing it to see through dust clouds and view redshifted light of distant galaxies.	Predominantly observed in the visible and ultraviolet light bands.
Has a primary mirror 6.5 meters in diameter.	Has a primary mirror 2.4 meters in diameter.
Far more light-gathering capability and resolution, enabling the detection of fainter and more distant objects.	Less light-gathering capability and resolution compared to James Webb Space Telescope.
Located at the second Lagrange point (L2), providing a more stable vantage point and uninterrupted sky observation.	In low Earth orbit, which is less stable than L2.

Beta Pictoris b: Hide and Seek

Consider the following statements about James Webb Space Telescope (JWST):

1. It is the largest observatory ever launched into space.
2. It has been developed by NASA in partnership with the European Space Agency and the Canadian Space Agency.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

This question was previously asked in

CDS 02/2022 General
Knowledge Official Paper (Held...

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1. 1 only

2. 2 only

3. Both 1 and 2

4. Neither 1 nor 2

Mains Question [2022]

Launched on 25th December, 2021, James Webb Space Telescope has been much in the news since then. What are its unique features which make it superior to its predecessor Space Telescopes ? What are the key goals of this mission ? What potential benefits does it hold for the human race? (Answer in 250 words) 15

How a New Law Aims to Place 'Vande Mataram' on a Par With 'Jana Gana Mana'

How a new law aims to place 'Vande Mataram' on a par with 'Jana Gana Mana'

Vineet Bhalla

New Delhi, July 21

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah is set to introduce the Prevention of Insults to National Honour (Amendment) Bill, 2026, in Rajya Sabha during the Monsoon Session. This will amend the Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971, to grant the national song, *Vande Mataram*, the same statutory protection currently given to the national anthem, *Jana Gana Mana*.

According to Section 3 of the Act, intentionally preventing the singing of the national anthem or causing a disturbance to any assembly engaged in such singing is a criminal offence punishable with imprisonment of up to three years, a fine or both. The Bill proposes to include the national song within the ambit of this section.

Legal status of national song

This year, the Ministry of Home Affairs issued guidelines regarding the singing and playing of the national song. The "orders

relating to the National Song of India" detailed the authorised lyrics, written by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee, and specified occasions for its mass singing, such as "on the unfurling of the National Flag, on cultural occasions or ceremonial functions".

The orders also stated that "whenever the official version of the National Song is sung or played, the audience shall stand to attention", and suggested that "in all schools, the day's work may begin with community singing of the National Song".

A petition, filed in the Supreme Court by one Muhammed Sayeed Noori, challenged the directives. Arguing for him, Senior Advocate Sanjay Hegde questioned whether people could be "compelled to sing the song in the garb of an advisory".

A three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, however, dismissed the plea as "premature" and based on a "vague apprehension of discrimination". The court said that the government's directive was advisory in nature and there were no penal consequences for those who

chose not to sing the national song.

How it differs from the national anthem

The Statement of Objects and Reasons of the Bill states that on January 24, 1950, Constituent Assembly President Rajendra Prasad declared that '*Vande Mataram*' should be "honoured equally" and have "equal status" with '*Jana Gana Mana*'. It then states that "presently, there is no specific legal provision to prevent insults" to the national song.

The national anthem and the national song, however, don't have equal status within the legal framework. Under Article 51A(a) of the Constitution, it is a fundamental duty of every citizen to respect the national flag and the national anthem. The national song is not mentioned here or anywhere else in the Constitution.

This distinction is also reflected in the government's executive orders containing guidelines on both. While the playing of both is recommended for the arrival of the

President, a Governor or a Lieutenant Governor at state functions, immediately before and after the President addresses the nation over All India Radio and "[w]hen the National Flag is brought on parade", the anthem is additionally mandated for "Civil and Military investitures", during parades, for "hoisting of colours in the Navy" and "when the Regimental Colours are presented".

The orders for the national song exclude such military protocols, specifying its playing only for "civil investitures".

Disrupting anthem's singing

To understand how the amended law might operate, one might look at how courts have interpreted the existing Section 3 of the 1971 Act, which currently applies only to the national anthem.

In 2014, the Kerala High Court in *Salman v. State of Kerala* clarified what constitutes such a disturbance. The court refused to quash an FIR against the petitioner, accused of "making noise and hue and cry" while the national anthem was being sung.

Justice P Ubaid held that "causing obstruction or prevention to the singing of National Anthem, by making loud or contemptuous noise" falls under the offence defined in Section 3 of the Act and ruled that such serious allegations require police investigation.

Right to respectful silence

While actively disrupting the singing of the national anthem is an offence under the Act, the Supreme Court distinguished this from simply choosing not to sing in the landmark *Bijoe Emmanuel & Ors v. State of Kerala* judgment of 1986.

The case involved three children belonging to the Jehovah's Witnesses Christian sect who were expelled from school for refusing to sing the national anthem during a morning assembly, even though they stood respectfully in silence while it was sung. Their refusal was based in their religious faith that did not permit them to sing praises to anyone except in prayers to their God.

The Supreme Court ruled in favour of

the students, holding that their expulsion violated their fundamental rights to freedom of speech and expression under Article 19(1)(a) and freedom of religion under Article 25(1) of the Constitution.

The court held that there is no legal provision obliging anyone to sing the national anthem. "Proper respect is shown to the National Anthem by standing up when the National Anthem is sung," the court said. "It will not be right to say that disrespect is shown by not joining in the singing."

The court emphasised the importance of religious freedom, observing, "Article 25 is an article of faith in the Constitution, incorporated in recognition of the principle that the real test of a true democracy is the ability of even an insignificant minority to find its identity under the country's Constitution."

In the conclusion to its judgment, the bench of Justices O Chinnappa Reddy and M M Dutt remarked: "Our tradition teaches tolerance; our philosophy preaches tolerance; our constitution practices tolerance; let us not dilute it."

How a New Law Aims to Place 'Vande Mataram' on a Par With 'Jana Gana Mana'

- **Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971**
 - Enacted to penalise acts of disrespect to the **National Flag, the Constitution, and the National Anthem**
 - Section 3 specifically criminalises preventing the singing of the national anthem or causing disturbance to an assembly engaged in singing it
- **Constitutional Basis**
 - Article 51A(a) places a Fundamental Duty on every citizen to respect the National Flag and National Anthem : the **National Song finds no mention**
 - Article 19(1)(a) (freedom of speech and expression) and Article 25(1) (freedom of conscience and religion) are both invoked in cases balancing compulsion to sing against individual rights
- **History of Vande Mataram**
 - Written by Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay, first published in his 1882 novel Anandamath
 - India's Constitution does not explicitly mention a national song.

Building an Atmanirbhar Philanthropy Ecosystem

Building an Atmanirbhar philanthropy ecosystem

India's philanthropic landscape has changed more in the past decade than many realise. Domestic private giving – through family philanthropy, Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), and individual donors – has grown rapidly and now far outstrips annual foreign philanthropic inflows. A new generation of entrepreneurs is rethinking differently about giving, while millions of Indians are entering the markets through mutual funds, systematic investment plans (SIP), and Unified Payments Interface (UPI). Against this backdrop, the debate around the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) takes on a different meaning: less a dispute about foreign funding than a chapter in India's move toward a more self-reliant philanthropic future.

The first principle should not be controversial. Every sovereign nation has both the right and the responsibility to regulate foreign capital flowing into organisations that shape public life. This is neither unique to India nor illiberal: the United States requires disclosure under its Foreign Agents Registration Act, and Australia and several European democracies run comparable regimes. The question worth debating is not whether foreign funding should be regulated, but whether that regulation is proportionate, predictable and efficiently run.

There is also a gap between perception and reality. The impression is that tighter FCRA rules have hollowed out Indian development work; the numbers say otherwise. NITI Aayog's portal NGO Darpan portal lists roughly six lakh voluntary organisations, of which only about 14,500 hold active FCRA registration. Foreign contributions have themselves doubled over the decade, from about ₹10,000 crore to around ₹22,000 crore. The sector has not been starved of money from abroad.

The rise of domestic giving

The bigger change lies at home. Domestic private philanthropy now exceeds ₹1.18 lakh crore a year – more than five times foreign inflows – according to the Bain-Dasra India Philanthropy Report 2026.

Family philanthropy is growing at double-digit rates as a new generation of wealth creators comes to see giving as part of wealth stewardship. The centre of gravity of Indian philanthropy has quietly shifted home.

None of this erases the hardship of the transition. A small number of organisations faced delayed renewals, long processing times, or cancelled registrations, disrupting work in



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education, health, livelihoods, and rural development. This was not true of the sector as a whole, but for those affected, the disruption was real and deserves acknowledgement rather than dismissal.

The transition also exposed how unevenly the sector had prepared. Many organisations operate with exemplary governance; others had gone dormant or were well-meaning groups whose documentation had not kept pace with rising expectations.

India's companies went through a similar reckoning over the past three decades: stronger governance initially felt like a burden, but it ultimately became the very thing that won investor confidence and drew in capital. The social sector can follow the same path. If money is the fuel of philanthropy, trust is its currency.

Better, not tighter regulation

The goal should be better regulation, not just tighter regulation. An administrative slip should not carry the same penalty as fraud. A structured path comprising deficiency notices, defined windows to correct errors, opportunities to provide clarification, and an independent appellate body would protect the integrity of the law while sparing genuine organisations avoidable disruption. The newly launched FCRA 2.0 platform offers a real opportunity to simplify compliance and move towards risk-based supervision.

Fixing FCRA's administration, though, is only half the task; the larger prize is to build what we would call an Atmanirbhar ('self-reliant') philanthropy ecosystem. India's giving has moved through three phases: first, a reliance on foreign philanthropy, and second, the transformation wrought by CSR, which now channels over ₹40,000 crore a year into development. The third phase must be powered by Indian families, entrepreneurs and citizens.

The most immediate opportunity sits with India's fast-growing community of high-net-worth individuals, whose giving has lagged well behind the growth in their wealth. This is where the largest pool of new domestic capital can be unlocked over the coming decade, and where policy can help most.

India's tax framework does not yet signal that philanthropy is a national priority. Deductions under Section 80G are usually limited to half the donation and capped at 10% of adjusted gross total income. Few large donors hit those limits, but tax policy is also about signalling intent – and other countries have been emphatic, from

Singapore's 250% deduction to Britain's Gift Aid top-up and America's carry-forward provisions. India need not copy them wholesale. But raising the 80G deduction from 50% to 100%, as is already allowed for some categories, and lifting the ceiling to 25%, would cost the exchequer little while meaningfully improving the flow of long-term social capital.

Expanding the donor base

One mechanism deserves particular mention. Most first-generation entrepreneurs hold their wealth in equity, not cash. A framework allowing donations of appreciated listed shares to eligible charities – with appropriate safeguards and a reasonable disposal window of, say, one to three years so that recipients can sell in orderly fashion – could become one of the most powerful ways to unlock domestic philanthropic capital.

The next frontier, over a longer horizon, is to widen the base. India now has over 220 million demat accounts, widespread SIP investing and UPI in every pocket; the infrastructure for mass participation already exists. If even a fraction of households gave ₹100, ₹500 or ₹1,000 a month through trusted digital platforms, millions of citizens would become active partners in solving the country's social problems. The Social Stock Exchange could do for social capital what India's markets did for financial capital – a trusted national platform linking credible organisations to ordinary citizens through clear disclosure and measurable impact.

The argument runs deeper than the sums involved. Domestic philanthropy creates more than money; it creates ownership. When Indian citizens and businesses fund India's own social challenges, they bring governance, ideas, volunteering and accountability along with their capital, strengthening not just the non-profit sector but also the wider social contract. That is the real case for an Atmanirbhar philanthropy ecosystem.

Foreign philanthropy will still matter, particularly in research, innovation and the exchange of ideas. But as India approaches developed-nation status, it should complement India's social development, not shape it. The aspiration, in the end, is not merely to regulate foreign philanthropy well. It is to build a country where the overwhelming share of social transformation is financed, led and owned by Indians themselves.

That is the promise of an Atmanirbhar philanthropy ecosystem – and, we believe, the next chapter of India's development story.

Domestic giving, not foreign funding, is what will define India's philanthropic future

Building an Atmanirbhar Philanthropy Ecosystem

Changing Philanthropic Landscape

○ Domestic private giving through family philanthropy, Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR), and individual donors has grown rapidly and now far outstrips annual foreign philanthropic inflows

○ Domestic private philanthropy now exceeds ₹1.18 lakh crore a year, more than five times foreign inflows, according to the Bain-Dasra India Philanthropy Report 2026

Corporate Social Responsibility

- In India, the CSR framework is established by Section 135 of the Companies Act, 2013, which mandates eligible companies to contribute towards societal development.
- Eligibility Criteria for CSR: The CSR law applies to companies that meet any of the following criteria: a net worth of ₹500 crore or more, an annual turnover of ₹1,000 crore or more, or a net profit of ₹5 crore or more in the previous financial year.
- CSR Spend Requirement: Eligible companies must allocate at least 2% of their average net profit from the previous 3 years towards CSR activities.

Building an Atmanirbhar Philanthropy Ecosystem

- **Permitted Activities (Schedule VII): Companies cannot spend CSR funds on just anything. The activity must fall under Schedule VII of the Act, which includes:**
 - **Eradication of hunger, poverty and malnutrition; healthcare, sanitation and safe drinking water**
 - **Promotion of education, vocational skills and livelihood enhancement.**
 - **Gender equality, women empowerment and support for senior citizens and vulnerable groups**
 - **Environmental sustainability, ecological balance and conservation of natural resources**
 - **Protection and promotion of national heritage, art, culture and traditional crafts**
 - **Welfare of armed forces, CAPF and paramilitary veterans and their dependents**
 - **Promotion of rural, national, Paralympic and Olympic sports**
 - **Contributions to Prime Minister's relief and other government welfare funds**
 - **Support to research, innovation, incubators and public-funded institutions aligned with SDGs**

Building an Atmanirbhar Philanthropy Ecosystem

With reference to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) rules in India, consider the following statements :

1. CSR rules specify that expenditures that benefit the company directly or its employees will not be considered as CSR activities.
2. CSR rules do not specify minimum spending on CSR activities.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

This question was previously asked in

UPSC CSE Prelims 2024: General Studies Official Paper

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1. 1 only

2. 2 only

3. Both 1 and 2

4. Neither 1 nor 2

From 1991, Three Foreign Policy Lessons for Managing Disruption of Certainties



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

HISTORICAL ANALOGIES must be approached with caution. Yet there is a striking symmetry between the foreign policy challenges that confronted India in 1990-91 and those now posed by the wars in Iran and Ukraine. Simultaneous upheavals in the Middle East and Europe in 1991 shattered India's economic and strategic assumptions. Today, the two regions are again compelling Delhi to reconsider the foundations of its national strategy.

Iraq's invasion of Kuwait in August 1990, and the US-led war to reverse Saddam Hussein's annexation, sent oil prices soaring, disrupted remittances and aggravated India's balance-of-payments crisis. Within months, the Soviet Union — the principal anchor of Indian foreign policy during the Cold War — collapsed. The twin shocks forced India to reform its economy, diversify its international partnerships and rethink its place in the world.

The circumstances today are different, but the underlying challenges are familiar. The war that began with the killing of Iran's Supreme Leader on February 28 has raised energy costs, disrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz and exposed India's dependence on the Middle East.

The relief in Delhi after Washington and Tehran signed a memorandum of understanding in June has proved premature as the conflict escalates again. In Europe, meanwhile, the Ukraine war has entered its fifth year without a clear path to settlement. Russia is not about to disintegrate as the Soviet Union did in 1991. But the prolonged war, with its mounting costs, is generating new questions about Russia's future at home and abroad.

India is much better placed to manage these shocks than it was in 1991. It has a larger economy, greater diplomatic weight, and wider international partnerships. Yet its ex-

posure to the world and the resulting vulnerabilities are greater.

American policies are intensifying this vulnerability. The sanctions legislation associated with the late Senator Lindsey Graham is proposing massive punitive tariffs against China, India and others importing Russian oil. President Donald Trump has also called for the legislation to be expanded to cover Iran. Whether or not Congress accepts that proposal, India's energy diplomacy will come under increasing stress.

The Indian government has shown considerable flexibility in navigating these pressures so far, but it could get trickier in the days ahead. As in 1991, however, the government appears more flexible than the foreign policy debate surrounding it might suggest. When Saddam invaded Kuwait, India's official position was caught between competing imperatives. It had to evacuate a large Indian expatriate population, preserve relations with Iraq and the Arab world, respond to the violation of Kuwaiti sovereignty, and accommodate the overwhelming military power assembled by the United States. The government's contradictory manoeuvres — including Foreign Minister I K Gujral's embrace of Saddam and

Iraq's invasion of Kuwait in August 1990, and the US-led war to reverse Saddam Hussein's annexation, sent oil prices soaring, disrupted remittances and aggravated India's balance-of-payments crisis

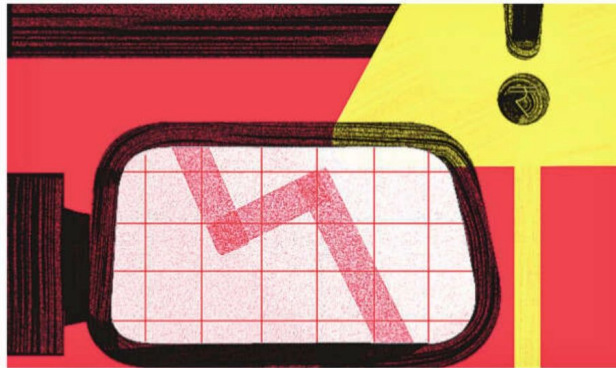


ILLUSTRATION: C R SASKUMAR

the provision of refuelling facilities to American military aircraft — reflected these multiple pressures.

But the domestic strategic consensus in 1991 was hardly realistic. Large sections of the political and foreign policy establishment sympathised instinctively with Saddam, long viewed as a friend of India and a representative of secular Arab nationalism. His annexation of an independent country was viewed as less important than his confrontation with the United States.

The same rigidity shaped Indian reactions to the Soviet crisis. By the late 1980s, Mikhail Gorbachev's internal reforms and retrenchment abroad had made clear that the old Soviet order was unsustainable. Yet a large section of Delhi's foreign policy community denounced him for seeking accommodation with the West. When communist hardliners attempted a coup in August 1991, there was barely concealed political glee in parts of Delhi. The coup collapsed within three days; the Soviet Union disappeared in December.

The protagonists have changed, but the instinct survives. Sympathy for Tehran often rests less on the character or conduct of the Islamic Republic than on its resistance to

America. Saddam's secular autocracy and Iran's Islamic theocracy are as different as chalk and cheese. Yet, the Indian foreign policy community embraced them both as symbols of anti-American defiance.

The debate on Russia is similarly personalised around Putin and sentimentalised through the memory of Soviet support for India. This obscures the need to examine Russia's internal strains, its changing relationship with China and its imperatives for reconciling with Europe and America. India's interests require an empathetic understanding of the domestic politics of Russia and Iran — not reflexive signalling of solidarity to the governments of the moment.

The first lesson from 1991, therefore, is that no balance of power is permanent. The certainties of the 1980s — a stable Soviet Union, a bipolar order and dependable partnerships — vanished with astonishing speed in 1991. Unpredictability is not an interruption of normal international politics; it is one of its permanent features. Indian strategy must devote as much attention to discontinuity as to continuity.

The second is that debate itself is a strategic asset. A foreign policy community organised around a rigid consensus will repeatedly miss inconvenient possibilities. India needs stronger expertise on Russia, Iran, Central Asia and the internal politics of the Middle East. India needs sustained investment, more than ever, in languages, history and regional specialisation. It also needs institutions willing to reflect on competing scenarios and encourage contrarian judgments.

The third and most important lesson is that external shocks and systemic changes cannot be managed by diplomacy alone. What rescued India after 1991 were the internal reforms. The answer must be the same today — sweeping domestic reform to cope with a changing world. Diplomacy's role then and now is to support internal transformation.

The writer is a contributing editor on international affairs for The Indian Express. He is also a Distinguished Professor at the Motwani-Jadeja Institute of American Studies, Jindal Global University and the Korea Foundation Chair on Asian Geopolitics at the Council for Strategic and Defense Research, Delhi

From 1991, Three Foreign Policy Lessons for Managing Disruption of Certainties

● The Historical Parallel

- The author draws a symmetry between India's 1990-91 foreign policy crisis and today's simultaneous upheavals in the Middle East (Iran) and Europe (Ukraine)
- Iraq's invasion of Kuwait (August 1990) and the subsequent US-led war sent oil prices soaring, disrupted remittances, and aggravated India's balance-of-payments crisis; within months, the Soviet Union, India's principal Cold War anchor collapsed
- Today, the war following the killing of Iran's Supreme Leader on February 28 has raised energy costs, disrupted navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, and exposed India's dependence on the Middle East; the Ukraine war has entered its fifth year without a clear path to settlement

● India's Improved but Still Exposed Position

- India is better placed today, a larger economy, greater diplomatic weight, and wider international partnerships but its exposure to global shocks remains significant
- US sanctions legislation proposes massive punitive tariffs on countries importing Russian oil, including India and China; there have been calls to extend this to Iran as well

From 1991, Three Foreign Policy Lessons for Managing Disruption of Certainties

● Three Lessons From 1991

- First, no balance of power is permanent, the certainties of the 1980s vanished with astonishing speed in 1991; unpredictability is a permanent feature of international politics, not an interruption of it
- Second, debate itself is a strategic asset, a rigid foreign-policy consensus causes India to miss inconvenient possibilities; India needs stronger expertise on Russia, Iran, Central Asia, and Middle East internal politics
- Third, external shocks and systemic changes cannot be managed by diplomacy alone, what rescued India after 1991 were internal economic reforms; the answer today must again be sweeping domestic reform

Thank You